Dollywood: Family, 2 Days

Park Day 1 = Trip Day 2 · Park Day 2 = Trip Day 4 · Smoky Mountain Christmas · Park 10 AM–9 PM · all times Eastern (park local time) · Lights ~5:30 PM · No parade in 2026 · Evenings mid-30s °F

Ground rules: One adult (Mom) does not ride and holds whichever kid isn't riding. The party is Dad, Mom, an older kid, a toddler, two grandparents (one on a scooter or wheelchair), and an older adult rider (who likes higher-thrill coasters). Dad rides with the older kid (42"–47.9") or the toddler (~31", no-minimum rides only), one at a time. The older adult rider can ride the 48"+ coasters the older kid can't.
Map numbers: A = Park Day 1 and B = Park Day 2. The color shows who it's for: pink = the older kid, green = the toddler, gold = Family. The key on the last page lists every ride and shop in each number.

Park Day 1 (Trip Day 2): Back of the park to the front, ending at the exit

> **Showstreet → Timber Canyon → Wildwood Grove → Wilderness Pass → Craftsman's Valley → Owens Farm → The Village → Rivertown → Pines Theater → Showstreet / Exit**

Time	Area	Plan	Map
10:00–11:45 *(arrive ~10:30)*	Timber Canyon → Wildwood Grove	Head to the back at opening. It's an uphill climb of about 25–30 minutes at the group's pace (it was 10–15), so skip A1 unless it's quick. the older kid rides with Dad (optional Timber Canyon kiddie rides on the way, then the Wildwood Grove family coasters and swings) plus face painting. the toddler's turns are the toddler rides and Hidden Hollow indoor play, with Mom.	A1–A3
11:45	Wildwood Grove	Early lunch at Till & Harvest.	A4
12:45–1:35	Wilderness Pass → Craftsman's Valley	The older kid: FireChaser + Blazing Fury. Then family crafts, eagles, Christmas shop and cinnamon bread.	A5–A6
1:35–2:05	Owens Farm → The Village	Kid play areas, then the Village Carousel. Leave the Village by 2:05.	A7–A8
2:45	Pines Theater (Jukebox Junction)	**'Twas the Night Before Christmas**. The walk through Rivertown is about 20 minutes at the group's pace. Be seated by 2:25 so there's time for wheelchair seating. the toddler naps.	A9
3:45	Rivertown Junction	3-minute walk back. Pond lights and shops for Mom.	A10
5:00	Dolly Parton Experience	Optional museums on the way to the gate. Lights come on about 5:30.	A11
5:45	Showstreet	Dinner at **Front Porch Café**. No reservations, so beat the dinner rush. The kitchen reportedly closes about 7.	A12

6:45–7:45	Showstreet	Shops by the gate and tree photos. Exit about 7:45.	A13

Park Day 2 (Trip Day 4): Country Fair, then west for lunch and the show, then up the valley to Wildwood Grove

> **Showstreet → Country Fair → back west to Front Porch Café and Celebrity Theater → Dreamsong (Heartsong) → Rivertown → The Village → up Craftsman's Valley (carolers, dinner) → Wilderness Pass → Wildwood Grove (Mad Mockingbird, Snow in the Grove) → downhill through Timber Canyon to the exit**

Carolers times (5:00 / 5:45) come from a published Christmas schedule that may be from a prior year; confirm in the app on Park Day 2 morning. Heartsong showtimes (hourly 12:00–7:00) are as given for Park Day 2.

Time	Area	Plan
10:00–12:00	Country Fair (Peppermint Valley)	First stop: the Country Fair rides. The older kid rides with Dad, and the toddler does Lemon Twist and Flying Elephants in between. Dad may not fit on some kiddie rides. Leave by 12:00 for the walk back to Showstreet (about 20–25 minutes at the group's pace).
12:15–1:10	Showstreet	Lunch at **Front Porch Café** (#19), next to Celebrity Theater. No reservations; the kitchen reportedly closes around 7. Be finished in time to be seated next door by 1:25.
1:45	DP's Celebrity Theater (Showstreet)	**Christmas in the Smokies**. Be seated by 1:25 so there's time for wheelchair seating. The show is about 50 minutes, so you're out around 2:35.
3:00	Dreamsong Theater (Dolly Parton Experience)	**Heartsong** (film, about 20 minutes), in the same cluster as Celebrity Theater. It runs every hour on the hour from 12:00 to 7:00, so another showing works if 3:00 doesn't fit. Out around 3:20.
~3:30	Back Porch Theater (Rivertown)	*Optional:* **Appalachian Christmas**, about 20 minutes, on the walk east to The Village. **2026 showtimes aren't posted yet; check the app and skip it if the times don't fit.*
3:50–4:30	The Village	Carousel or Imagination Playhouse, Temple's Mercantile, holiday snacks. (The Dollywood Express, if you want it after dark, leaves from the depot here — see the evening note below.)
4:30–4:55	Craftsman's Valley (walking up)	About 15 minutes uphill at the group's pace. Valley Crafts, Smoky Creek Leather and Old Flames Candles, plus Grist Mill cinnamon bread if you want another loaf. *Optional for the older adult rider:* **Tennessee Tornado** (48"+, Craftsman's Valley; the older kid can't ride).
5:00	Robert F. Thomas Chapel steps (#51)	**Candlelight Carolers** (definite): a stationary set of about 15 minutes on the chapel steps. Be there by 5:00. If you're running late, the next set is around 5:45, and dinner can wait.

~5:20–6:20	Craftsman's Valley	Dinner at **Hickory House BBQ** (#70, definite), a short walk farther up the valley from the chapel.
~6:30–6:55	Wilderness Pass	About 10–15 minutes farther up. *Optional for the older kid:* **FireChaser Express** (39", Wilderness Pass; under 48" needs someone 14+). *Optional for the older adult rider:* **Wild Eagle** (50", Wilderness Pass; the older kid can't ride).
~7:15	Wildwood Grove	The climb from Wilderness Pass is about 15–20 minutes at the group's pace. **Must-do: Mad Mockingbird** (36"; under 48" must ride with someone 14 or older — the older kid rides with Dad). She couldn't ride it on Park Day 1. Also **Great Tree Swing** (36", same grove; under 48" needs someone 14+). It can close in rain, wind, or at 32°F, so check the app if the evening is wet or very cold. *Optional for the older kid:* **Dragonflier** (39"; under 48" needs someone 14+).
~8:00	Wildwood Grove	**Snow in the Grove** runs every 30 minutes from 6:00, so the 8:00 showing is the plan after the rides; use 7:30 if you skip Dragonflier. Hot cocoa at Till & Harvest.
~8:15	Timber Canyon → exit	About 20–30 minutes downhill to the gate (park closes at 9:00). *Optional for the older kid on the way out:* **Whistle Punk Chaser** (36", Timber Canyon; under 42" needs someone 14+, so the older kid at 42"–47.9" may ride solo).

Evening, nice-to-have: The **Dollywood Express** after dark (~20-minute round trip from The Village depot). Arrive 20 minutes early; departures are limited, so check the app. ECV users transfer to board. The depot is at the east end of the park, the opposite direction from Wildwood Grove after dinner, so scratch the train if dinner runs long or if you're heading on to Mad Mockingbird and Snow in the Grove. Village shops after dinner are a suggestion only if you skip or wrap the Wildwood evening early.

Accessibility & pace (grandparents)

- **Pace:** The group is 9 people with a scooter, a stroller and one adult not riding, so every walk between zones is planned at 1.5–2 times the normal time. Plan for 20–30 minutes on any cross-park walk and 25–30 minutes on the climbs.
- **Hills:** The steepest stretches are the climb from Showstreet through Timber Canyon to Wildwood Grove, Craftsman's Valley (uphill toward Wilderness Pass) and the drop into Jukebox Junction. Each day's route takes the climbs while everyone is fresh, and the evening exit is downhill. Use the Dollywood app's **"accessible routes"** feature. The park map marks paths where wheelchairs and ECVs aren't recommended.
- **Scooter rental:** Dollywood rents single-rider ECVs (scooters) and wheelchairs by the day. Some ECVs can be reserved online at least 48 hours ahead. If you don't already have a Park Day 2 reservation, ask at the rental stand when you arrive; the rest are first come, first served. Rules: the rider must be 16 or older, the weight limit is 400 lb, and a personal device can be up to 36 in wide by 52 in long.
- **Ride Accessibility Center** (next to the Emporium, just inside the gate): stop here first if anyone needs a ride Boarding Pass. It lets the holder and up to 5 companions use the accessible entrance, but it isn't a skip-the-line pass, and the holder has to ride. The kids' rides are planned with the standard lines, so this matters only if a grandparent rides.

- **Show seating:** wheelchair and companion seating at the Celebrity, Pines, Valley and Back Porch theaters is first come, first served. Arrive 15–20 minutes early; the seat-by times above already include this.*
- **Companion care restrooms:** Showstreet, Country Fair, Craftsman's Valley, Owens Farm, Village First Aid and Wilderness Pass. Adult changing tables are on Showstreet, in Wilderness Pass, in Wildwood Grove (next to Treetop Tower and Hidden Hollow) and at Village First Aid.
- **Trams and train:** The free parking trams, including accessible trams, run only between the lots and the front gate. The Dollywood Express is a round-trip scenic ride, not a way to get around the park, so plan to roll or walk everywhere.*
- *Sources: dollywood.com/accessibility/dollywood-theme-park; themeparkaccess.org (2026 Rider Safety & Accessibility Guide); thoosie.app. *Theater seating details and whether the train takes wheelchairs aren't confirmed; ask at the Ride Accessibility Center.*

Practical notes

- **Cold weather:** Evenings are in the mid-30s °F. Bring layers, hats, gloves and a stroller wind cover. Skip Daredevil Falls and the Wildwood Creek splash pad because they're too cold. Indoor shows double as warm-ups and nap time.
- **Heights:** The older kid is still too short for the 48"+ rides (Tornado, Lightning Rod, Mystery Mine, Thunderhead, Wild Eagle, Drop Line, Barnstormer); those are the ones for the older adult rider if he wants them. Riders under 42"/48" on some rides need someone 14 or older with them. Heights checked against dollywood.com and the official 2026 map: Mad Mockingbird and Great Tree Swing 36" (under 48" with someone 14+), Whistle Punk Chaser 36", Dragonflier and FireChaser Express 39" (under 48" with someone 14+), Tennessee Tornado 48", Wild Eagle 50". Check the posted heights.
- **Shows:** Seating is first come, first served. TimeSaver reserved seating is offered at the Celebrity and Pines theaters. Check the app each morning for showtimes.
- **Dixie Stampede:** The toddler is free as a lap child. The 8:30 show lets out about 10 PM, so a non-park night or the 6:00 show is better.

Open questions

1. Which night for the Stampede?
2. Will anyone else from the group help with rides?
3. Nap at the lodging instead of in the park?
4. Buy the Tasting Pass ($45.99)?
5. Is the older kid up for the bigger family coasters?
6. If Dad doesn't fit on the kiddie rides, does the older kid ride solo or skip?

The annotated park map and key are in the separate Dollywood-Map.pdf.